

Employees Grievance Redressal Guidelines

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Prepared By	Head- Business HR
Reviewed By	Chief Human Resource Officer
Approved By	Committee of HR
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Revision History

The Revision History table below provides a record of all revisions made to this document throughout its lifecycle. Updates are tracked by the date the revisions were made, the version number, a brief description of the changes made and their reason, and the names of the reviser and the approver.

Effective Date	Version #	Change Description / Reason	Prepared / Revised By	Reviewed By	Approved By
1 st November 2024	1.0	New Guidelines Introduced	Head Business HR	Chief Human Resource Officer	Committee of HR

1. Guiding Principles

1.1 Introduction

At **Poonawalla Fincorp Limited** (Hereinafter referred to as “PFL”), we recognize that our employees are our most valuable asset. In alignment with our organization’s values, **CREDIT**, we strive to provide a workplace for our employees wherein any employee concerns about employment issues are heard. To this end, we have in place comprehensive “**Employee Grievance Redressal Guidelines**”, which are designed to address and resolve any concerns or issues that may arise in the workplace.

The grievances relating to issues of non-promotion, ratings, salaries, transfer/posting/deputation/redeployments, and other administrative matters will first need to be raised through appropriate channels available in the organization.

1.2 Objective:

- 1.2.1 Promote Fairness and Transparency: We are committed to maintaining a fair and transparent process for addressing grievances, ensuring that all employees are treated with respect and dignity.
- 1.2.2 Encourage Open Communication: We foster an environment where employees feel comfortable voicing their concerns without fear of retaliation.
- 1.2.3 Provide Timely Resolutions: We strive to resolve grievances promptly and efficiently, minimizing any disruption to the workplace.
- 1.2.4 Ensure Confidentiality: We handle all grievances with the utmost confidentiality to protect the privacy of our employees.

1.3 Scope & Applicability

These guidelines shall be called the “**Employee Grievance Redressal Guidelines**”. The grievance redressal mechanism created under these guidelines is applicable to all employees of PFL working at its corporate office, regional branches, and any other premises under the company. The redressal process is non-statutory, governed by PFL’s internal procedural standards, and entirely at the discretion of PFL. Depending upon any statutory applicability of the Grievance Redressal Mechanism in the future, PFL shall review this guideline appropriately to align the same with the statutory mechanism.

2. Guidelines

2.1 Definitions

- 2.1.1 Concerned Employee – Means the employee of PFL who has raised a grievance as per these guidelines.
- 2.1.2 Employee – Means a full-time employee of PFL, includes on-roll employees, -, management trainees, retainers, interns, and fixed term appointees.
- 2.1.3 Grievance – Means and concern pertaining to work, relations at work, working environment, safety, health, discrimination, terms & conditions of employment, statutory benefits, code of conduct violations, any unfair practice or harassment at work other than sexual harassment, etc. raised to the designated authorities of PFL
- 2.1.4 Grievance Redressal Committee (GRC) - An independent committee with cross-department representation. Any three members of the Committee may form a quorum-
 - Chief Human Resource Officer
 - Chief Risk Officer
 - Chief Credit & Analytics Officer
 - Chief Internal Auditor (Will chair the committee OR, in the absence of CIA, the quorum will decide the chair for the committee discussion)
 - Chief Business Officer (Head of the Function)
- 2.1.5 Designated Authorities – Mean any of the following employees of PFL to whom the aggrieved person has raised or may raise a grievance
 - Head - Business Human Resources
 - Head - Employee Relations & Compliance
 - Head - Human Resources Shared Services
 - Immediate Supervisor (if he/she is not the subject matter of grievance) OR
 - Head of the Function / Department

2.2 Grievance Redressal Procedure

The following process should be followed for expressing and seeking redressal to a grievance

- 2.2.1 The “concerned employee” May communicate his/her grievance in writing to their respective immediate supervisor, in case the grievance involves the Manager, then the employee can contact the Manager’s Manager, while simultaneously copying his Manager
- 2.2.2 The concerned manager to whom the grievance is raised must immediately acknowledge receipt of the grievance in writing, informing the employee of the receipt of grievance and inviting the employee for a formal meeting.
- 2.2.3 If the grievance pertains to the same function where the employee works, the Manager has to review and resolve the same based on the feasibility or commit to

- a timeline by which the same could be resolved as per dependency on other departments / functions / vendors or factors.
- 2.2.4 In other cases, Manager may consult with the concerned departments or functions to which the grievance pertains to for their action or feedback and revert to the employee with a course of action / solution within 10 working days from the date of receipt of grievance
 - 2.2.5 In case an employee is not satisfied with the solution, the employee may choose to represent the grievance to designated authorities or by writing to the confidential email id redressal@poonawallafincorp.com
 - 2.2.6 The “concerned employee” should file their grievance immediately after experiencing the same or upon becoming aware of the same
 - 2.2.7 Grievances must be raised by clearly articulating and specifying the issue/concern, along with the supporting documents, if any, for the same to be considered for further investigation
 - 2.2.8 Depending upon the severity and sensitivity of the grievance, the designated authority shall forward the same to the GRC for its further investigation and or resolution
 - 2.2.9 The GRC shall endeavor to acknowledge the complaint within 48 hours, resolve it within 30 days from its receipt
 - 2.2.10 Upon receiving the details of the grievance from the designated authorities, the GRC committee will strive to resolve the same immediately by advising further investigation or inquiry. The committee shall advise the Head Business HR and Function Head / HOD (Optional) to further investigate/inquire into the grievance, in case there is no further investigation is required then employee who has raised the grievance should be communicated accordingly.
 - 2.2.11 The Investigating authority (Head Business HR and Function Head) shall prepare the summary of the grievance along with the solutions offered and refer the matter to the GRC for its final decision and recommendations.
 - 2.2.12 The GRC will give their recommendation to the designated authority within 15 working days. The designated authority will take a decision based on this recommendation and communicate their decision through the concerned designated authority to the aggrieved employee within 7 working days from the recommendation of the GRC.
 - 2.2.13 The GRC's decision about the grievance will be final and binding on all concerns
 - 2.2.14 Grievances will be treated with utmost confidentiality and sensitivity
 - 2.2.15 The members of the designated authority or the GRC shall conduct the matter in accordance with the principles of natural justice.
 - 2.2.16 The concerned employee shall fully participate and support any investigation or inquiry initiated by the GRC
 - 2.2.17 Head Business HR will arrange to send the relevant documents for future records in the personal file of the employee who has raised the grievance and also in the employee's file against whom any specific action is initiated by the organization

2.3 Confidentiality

All Parties concerned who have the knowledge of the incident in whatever capacity shall maintain confidentiality concerning the complaint, investigations, and any other material

information, including confidentiality of the persons supporting the investigations or inquiry.

2.4 Non-Retaliation

The aggrieved person or any person who, in good faith, has participated in the investigations or inquiry or has provided information pertaining to the grievance raised shall be protected from any kind of retaliation. PFL will observe zero tolerance in case of any such retaliation. Individuals engaging in retaliatory conduct will be subject to disciplinary action by the organization.

2.5 Gross misconduct

In case the grievance by an employee leads to discovery of gross misconduct by another employee(s) or associates or vendors, appropriate action will be taken by HR, while the identity of the complainant will not be disclosed in any manner or forum

2.6 Non-compliance and Consequence

Employees are restricted from sharing their personal grievances with other employees or co-workers in an order to garner their support / attention or attempt to disrupt their business activities and distract them with such topics which may or may not be relevant to them. This policy is put in place for employees to submit their grievance through a proper channel. Any deviation from the set protocol by any employee or employees will be dealt in accordance with the rules of this policy or any other such policies as appropriate by HR and management.

2.7 Supervisor's Roles & Responsibilities

- 2.7.1 It is important to deal with grievances when they first occur; it is best to try to prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Employees should have the opportunity to raise any concerns so they can be discussed and resolved.
- 2.7.2 As a manager, you should always encourage two-way communication with the employees in day-to-day management by holding regular one-on-ones. This will enable employees to raise concerns at an early stage before the matter becomes more serious.
- 2.7.3 Supervisors should conduct themselves in a fair manner, with an open mind and in a non-discriminatory manner.
- 2.7.4 If Supervisors are uncertain, they should seek their respective BHR advice at any stage of the process.

3. Governance

3.1 Ownership & Approving Authority

- 3.1.1 Subject to approval from the Committee of HR (COHR)
- 3.1.2 The CHRO will propose to COHR any changes that are not substantive and are incidental or administrative in nature. COHR will approve any changes that are substantial in nature

3.2 Review

- 3.2.1 COHR shall review these guidelines periodically and make changes and modifications as and when necessary.
- 3.2.2 PFL shall be entitled to amend, change, vary and modify the contents of this document as and when required at its discretion or basis for any statutory changes that apply to PFL.
- 3.2.3** Any such amendment/modification shall be binding upon such categories of persons to whom these guidelines are applicable.

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